
You have 30 days. Nobody told you the **queue** is longer.

You sorted the flat. Now four government systems that don't talk to each other. Here's the order to do them in.

The 30-day clock applies to the ordinary non-EU study route over six months, and runs from entry — or from your favourable resolution if you applied from inside Spain. EU, EEA and Swiss students follow a different route entirely. Section 01 splits them.

30

DAYS TO APPLY FOR
YOUR TIE

3

REGISTRATIONS:
IMMIGRATION, TOWN
HALL, TRANSPORT

€16.08/€12

GOVERNMENT FEE, BY
ROUTE

3

TIMES YOU SHOW UP IN
PERSON, NON-EU

What's in here

Fourteen sections. Read 01 first, then jump to whatever you're stuck on. Everything in this guide can be done by you, for free, using official channels — the last section is there only if you'd rather not. Section 05 splits three ways: 05A non-EU, 05B EU/EEA/Swiss, 05C when the appointment won't come. Read yours and skip the others.

01	Pick your route EU or non-EU — everything downstream depends on this
02	The clock What is due when, including the wait nobody controls
03	Your first week Eight things to do before the paperwork starts
04	NIE, TIE, padrón, expediente Four words that are not interchangeable
05A	A — Getting your TIE Five steps, one photo spec, five ways to waste the trip
05B	B — EU registration certificate EX-18, €12, no fingerprints
05C	C — The appointment won't come in time What actually happens, and what to keep
06	Registering your address The evidence ladder, and what to do about a difficult landlord
07	Does yours still qualify? Four rejection criteria, and the date to diarise
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Pick your route first. Half this guide doesn't apply to you.

A large share of avoidable mistakes starts with following the wrong route. Your nationality decides which paperwork you do. Choose once and the guide will hide everything irrelevant.

ROUTE A

EU, EEA or Swiss passport

Staying more than 3 months? You apply for an **EU registration certificate** using form EX-18. It's a green paper certificate, not a photo card. No fingerprints. Fee is €12.

ROUTE B

Any other passport

Authorised to study for more than six months? You apply for a **TIE** — a physical photo card — using form EX-17, normally within one month of entry. Fingerprints required. Fee is €16.08.

Four situations that change your route entirely

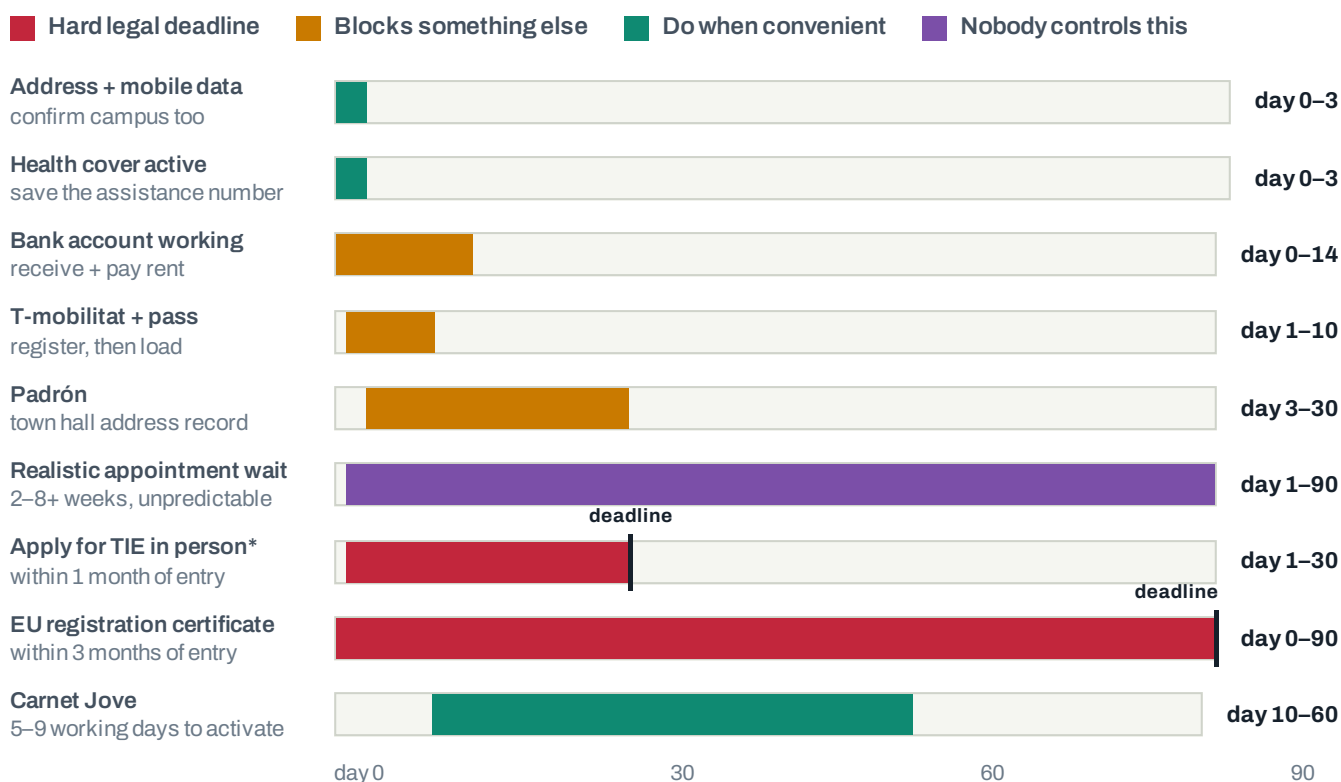
You already hold Spanish residence · you have EU-family rights through a spouse or parent · you're on an EU student-mobility arrangement · **you applied for your authorisation from inside Spain rather than at a consulate, in which case your one-month clock runs from notification of the favourable resolution, not from entry.** If any of these describe you, confirm with your university's international office *before* booking anything. Booking the wrong procedure wastes the appointment and you go back in the queue.

What is due when

Two of these are legal deadlines. The rest are things that quietly block the next step if you leave them. The bar shows the window you have; the marker shows when it closes.

Your first 90 days, to scale

Day 0 is the day you enter Spain



*See 05C if the calendar doesn't cooperate. Deadlines reflect the ordinary study routes described by the Ministry and the National Police. Your own authorisation document overrides anything shown here — read it.

03 – YOUR FIRST WEEK

Your first week

Nothing here involves a government office. It's the stuff that makes everything else possible. Tick them off as you go.

☐ Ask your landlord or head tenant, in writing, whether they will provide padrón paperwork — before you need it

☐ Email your international office: do they run group or block TIE appointments for this intake?

☐ Get working mobile data (home SIM roaming is fine for now)

☐ Check your health cover is active in Spain and save the assistance number

☐ Read your visa or authorisation and write down your registration deadline

☐ Put passport, visa, insurance, enrolment and rental docs in one folder

☐ Find your nearest copisteria now, not at 8am on appointment day

☐ Make sure you can receive money and pay rent from a working account

04 – VOCABULARY

NIE, TIE and padrón are three different things

This is the single most common confusion, and it costs people appointments. One is a number, one is a card, one is an address record. Having one does not give you the others.

A NUMBER

NIE

Número de Identidad de Extranjero

Your foreigner ID number. It's often **already printed on your visa or approval decision** — check before applying for one separately.

A NIE does not authorise you to stay.

If a NIE already appears on your visa sticker or resolution, **do not book a NIE appointment**. That is the most common wasted booking there is.

A PHOTO CARD

TIE

Tarjeta de Identidad de Extranjero

The physical card proving your authorised status. Non-EU students authorised for more than six months. Requires fingerprints in person.

Fee €16.08 · form EX-17

A CERTIFICATE

EU registration

Certificado de Registro de Ciudadano de la UE

Green paper certificate containing your NIE. Not photo ID — carry your passport or national ID alongside it, always.

Fee €12 · form EX-18

FREE · ADDRESS REGISTRATION

Padrón

Empadronamiento

Registering your address with the town hall. Proves where you live. Needed for health services, and often requested at your card appointment.

A padrón does not fix your immigration status.

A REFERENCE

Número de expediente

Your file number

Printed on your appointment confirmation and on every resolution. Quote it in **every** enquiry, email or phone call — without it, nobody can find you in the system.

Photograph it the day you get it.

Getting your TIE

Five steps, one of which you cannot control. Start on your first weekday in Spain — the appointment, not the paperwork, is the bottleneck.

1	Read your own authorisation first The TIE documents a permission you already hold. It does not create one. Check the dates and conditions on your visa or approval decision — if your stay is six months or less, you generally don't need a TIE at all.
2	Book the <i>cita previa</i> Official appointment portal → Barcelona province → the fingerprint/card-issuance procedure, usually labelled POLICÍA – TOMA DE HUELLAS. Booking a NIE-number appointment instead is the classic wasted trip. Slots release irregularly Check early morning Keep the confirmation
3	Fill EX-17 and pay tasa 790-012 Download the current EX-17 from the National Police student-card page. Generate Modelo 790 Código 012 and select the first-issuance category. Generating the form is not paying it — follow the banking instructions and keep the stamped proof. EX-17 790-012 €16.08
4	Attend in person with originals They check documents and take your fingerprints. Bring originals <i>and</i> a paper copy set. Names and passport/NIE numbers must match across every document. Do not rely on phone screenshots — bring originals and printed copies wherever the official checklist requires them.
5	Ask exactly how you collect it Some offices require a separate collection appointment. Ask whether your office issues same-day or requires a second collection appointment, and what the wait is. Ask where, when, and what to bring. Don't book flights around an assumed collection date — and check your re-entry position before travelling with a card still pending.

Bring all of this

- ☐ Appointment confirmation
- ☐ Completed, signed EX-17
- ☐ Original passport + the copies your office asks for
- ☐ Visa / authorisation decision
- ☐ Proof of entry — passport stamp or travel evidence
- ☐ Recent colour photo, 32 × 26 mm, plain white background, face forward, head uncovered, no tinted lenses
- ☐ Paid 790-012 receipt
- ☐ Padrón certificate, if your office requests it
- ☐ Current enrolment evidence, if requested

The five ways people waste the trip

Wrong appointment type. Booked NIE assignment instead of fingerprints.

Generated but never paid. The 790-012 needs a bank payment and a stamp.

Name mismatch. Middle names present on one document, missing on another.

Digital only. Relying on the phone when the checklist asks for paper.

Missing photocopies. Offices routinely want the passport bio page *and every stamped page*. Copy the lot.

Can't find an appointment? There is no legitimate way to guarantee appointment availability. What we can do is make sure that when you get one, nothing on your file sends you home again.

05B – EU / EEA / SWISS

Your registration certificate

Staying more than three months means registering within three months of entry. Shorter, simpler and cheaper than the non-EU route — but it is not automatic, and a NIE alone doesn't count as done.

1	Complete EX-18 This is the EU registration form. You do <i>not</i> use EX-17, and you do not give fingerprints.
2	Gather your four proofs Enrolment at a recognised institution · comprehensive health cover in Spain · a declaration of sufficient resources · and the address/registration evidence required for your local procedure. Enrolment letter EHIC or private policy Resources declaration Padrón
3	Pay tasa 790-012 — €12 Different amount from the non-EU card. Same rule applies: generating the form isn't paying it. Keep the stamped receipt.
4	Book EU citizen registration and attend Book through the official appointment system and go in person with originals and copies. Where requirements are met the certificate is normally issued at the appointment — but that says nothing about how long you'll wait for the appointment itself.

"I already have a NIE, so I'm registered." No.

A standalone NIE allocation is not EU registration. If you genuinely only need a number for one transaction during a short stay, the separate EX-15 route may fit — but it does not replace EX-18 when registration is required.

Your EHIC may be enough

An EHIC can satisfy the health cover requirement if it stays valid for the whole relevant period and gives the required entitlement. Check with your home insurer before buying Spanish private cover you may not need — starting work or changing your residence situation can change the position.

05C — WHEN IT WON'T COME

The appointment won't come in time

The cover of this guide told you that you have thirty days. Here is what actually happens when the portal has nothing inside thirty days, which in September is common. Read this before you panic about it.

First, the part that matters most

The one-month window is when you are expected to apply. It is **not** a cliff edge that voids your right to be here. Applications submitted after it are generally still processed, and what protects your status while you wait is the visa or authorisation you already hold — not the card. **The TIE documents a permission you already have; it does not create one.**

So the goal is not to beat the clock. The goal is to be able to show, later, that you tried.

Evidence discipline

This is the whole job. Every single time you check the portal and it shows no availability, **take a dated screenshot**. Full screen, with the date visible. Keep every one, in one folder, named by date.

Searching for an appointment is not the same as submitting an application. If your file is ever questioned, the screenshots are the difference between "I didn't get round to it" and "here is the system, empty, forty-one times."

How to actually look

Check daily, early. Slots release irregularly and go quickly. A check that takes ninety seconds, done every morning, beats an hour of refreshing once a week.

Confirm you are selecting the right procedure every time — the fingerprint/card procedure, not a NIE-assignment appointment.

Keep looking after you find one. If an earlier slot appears, you can usually rebook, but cancel the old one so somebody else gets it.

Do not buy an appointment

There is a market in resold appointments, and it exists because bots scrape the government booking system. In November 2024 the Policía Nacional dismantled one such network across Alicante, Murcia and Valencia — twenty-one arrests, with charges including unauthorised access to the state server, document falsification and belonging to a criminal organisation.

Set aside whether it works. The practical problem is that it puts your file, with your name on it, in the same investigation as the seller's other customers. There is no legitimate way to guarantee appointment availability, and anyone who tells you otherwise is selling you their risk.

When it stops being an admin problem

Talk to a qualified immigration professional — an *abogado* or a *gestor administrativo* — if any of these are true:

Your authorisation is close to expiring and you still have no appointment

You need to travel out of Spain with the card still pending

You arrived without the authorisation you thought you had

You have had an application refused, for anything

Your circumstances changed — you married, changed course, or stopped studying

We are not that professional, and we will tell you when you need one.

While you wait

Nothing else in this guide is blocked by the appointment. Do the padrón. Get the travel pass. Open the bank account. Check your insurance dates.

The padrón in particular is worth doing early: it is free, it does not depend on the appointment, and several offices ask to see it when you finally get there.

Before you travel abroad with a pending card, check your re-entry position. This is the single most common way a manageable situation becomes an expensive one.

06 – THE TOWN HALL

Registering your address

Free, quietly required by the step after it, and the one where a difficult landlord can genuinely stall you. It is also the part most students get wrong before they have even started.

The fact that unlocks most of this

You do not need to own the property or hold the lease to register. The padrón records where you actually live. It grants no tenancy right and no ownership claim — which is exactly why a landlord's refusal does not end the matter, and why their fear of "giving you rights" is misplaced.

Find your rung, then stop reading

Four situations. Most students who panic about this are on rung one and do not know it.

1

The contract is in your name

No landlord involvement needed at all. The contract is your proof, and they already signed it. Bring it with your ID and you are done. If this is you, the rest of this page is not your problem.

2

You rent a room, or the contract is in someone else's name

You need an express written authorisation from the person whose name is on the title or contract: **signed original, adult, plus a photocopy of their ID showing the same signature.**

The authoriser can be the owner *or* the tenant. Neither has to be registered there themselves — but they must evidence their own title. **Your head tenant can authorise you using their own rental contract.** That single sentence resolves most room-rental cases.

3

You live in a student residence

Authorisation from the establishment's titleholder. Usually routine — ask reception, they will have done it many times. If they say they don't do it, ask again in writing and name the person you spoke to.

You have no documentation at all

There is an official fallback. After you submit the application, municipal services verify by telephone and a visit to the address.

Be clear-eyed about the trade-offs: it is **slower**, you must be genuinely reachable and genuinely living there, and **your landlord may find out**, because a municipal officer arriving at the door is not discreet. It works. It is not frictionless.

Other evidence that is accepted

- ☐ *Escritura* — the deed, if you own
- ☐ *Nota simple* from the property register
- ☐ An IBI receipt
- ☐ A bank transfer from the last two months showing rent paid

Mobile and internet bills are explicitly not accepted. Neither is a utility bill in someone else's name.

Volant or certificat?

Students bring the wrong one, constantly.

Volant — informative. Fast, often instant online.

Certificat — carries *fe pública*, meaning it is the authenticated document. Separate request, takes longer.

Procedures that need proof rather than information will specify the **certificat**. Ask your appointment's own checklist which it wants — and if you cannot get a clear answer, take the **certificat**, because it satisfies anything the **volant** would have.

Booking it

An OAC appointment (*cita previa*) is required. Book it in week one, not week three — this queue is shorter than the immigration one, but it is not instant.

There is also an online route if you hold a digital certificate (**idCAT** or **Cl@ve**), which can skip the counter entirely.

What to expect

Roughly **seven calendar days** to the confirmation email, after which **volants** are available.

Your address must include **floor and door number**. "Carrer X 44" is not an address here; "Carrer X 44, 3r 2a" is.

It expires silently

Non-EU residents without long-term residence must **renew the registration every two years**. Miss it and the registration lapses without anyone telling you — and you find out at the worst moment.

Put the date in your calendar the day you register.

Never register at an address you do not live at

Barcelona has recorded falsified rental contracts and utility bills submitted for padrón registration. **Article 392 of the Criminal Code carries prison sentences and fines** for falsifying a document, and it attaches to your immigration file, where it will follow you through every renewal you ever apply for.

It is not worth it, it is not a shortcut, and we will refuse the job.

Does yours still qualify?

If you are non-EU and reading this in Barcelona, you bought insurance at the consulate months ago. So this section is not about what to buy. It is about whether what you already have will survive contact with the counter — and when it expires.

The four rejection criteria

Check your policy against these before your appointment, not at it.

- ☐ **No copayments.** The single biggest killer. A policy that charges you per visit is not comparable to public cover.
- ☐ **No waiting periods.** Cover that starts in three months does not cover you now.
- ☐ **Insurer authorised to operate in Spain.** A policy from home usually is not.
- ☐ **Dates covering the full authorised period** — not the academic year. These are different, and the gap is where people get caught.

EU, EEA and Swiss

An EHIC can satisfy the requirement if it stays valid for the whole relevant period and provides the required entitlement. Check with your home insurer rather than assuming.

Two things change the position: **starting work**, and **changing your residence situation**. Both are worth a five-minute call before they happen.

The policy that got you your visa may not get you your renewal

Some extranjería offices apply the criteria more strictly at renewal than the consulate did at issue, and some show a marked preference for Spanish insurers. If your policy came from a broker at home, find out now what renewing looks like — not eleven months from now.

Diarise your policy end date today. It is the single most commonly missed date in this entire guide.

You may be paying twice

Once registered on the padrón in Catalonia, many students can access CatSalut public healthcare and obtain a *targeta sanitària* (TSI). This does **not** replace the insurance requirement your authorisation imposes — you still need the policy for immigration purposes.

But it does mean you may have a public route for ordinary care while paying a private premium for a document. Worth knowing before you renew. Conditions vary by situation; check yours with CatSalut directly.

If you do need to buy

Three insurers offer student-specific products in Barcelona: **Sanitas**, **ASISA** and **DKV**. All three advertise no-copay options without waiting periods, all three issue a Spanish certificate, and all three price by individual quote.

We are not publishing indicative premiums, because the only number that matters is your quote for your dates and your age band. Compare **total payable** and the cancellation rules, and check there is a clinic and an English-speaking GP near you in that policy's directory before you buy.

REFERRAL DISCLOSURE

We may receive a referral fee from some insurers, including Sanitas. ASISA and DKV pay us nothing. We are not quoting prices for any of the three, so this page recommends none of them — get three quotes and pick on the criteria above. If we later help you buy, we will tell you at that point whether we are paid on it.

08 — PRACTICALITIES

What the admin costs, and the two accounts you need

Not a cost-of-living page. Just the money the paperwork itself takes, and the two things you need working to pay it.

The paperwork itself

Everything in this guide, start to finish

Tasa 790-012 — EU route	€12.00
Tasa 790-012 — non-EU TIE	€16.08
Padrón registration	€0
Passport photos, 32×26 mm	€6–12
Photocopies	€5–10
T-mobilitat card + 90-day T-jove	€46.50–50
Insurance, if you must buy	€0–65
Total, non-EU	€80–160

Government fees confirmed against the current tasa schedule. The padrón really is free — anyone charging you for it is charging for their time, not for the registration.

A bank account

You need one that does three things: **pay the tasa**, **receive money from home**, and **pay your rent**.

A Spanish IBAN is not legally required for a SEPA payment — an account in another EU member state should not be refused for that reason alone. In practice, **some landlords and most utility direct debits want an ES IBAN**, so get one if you can.

At every ATM and card terminal, choose euros. If a machine offers to bill you in your home currency, decline — that is dynamic currency conversion, and it is usually worse than letting your own bank or card network handle it.

A Spanish number

Three things matter and nothing else does:

Prepaid works on a passport. Contract plans generally want a NIE, which you may not have yet.

You want a +34 number for appointment SMS and delivery contact. A data-only travel eSIM often gives you no number at all.

"€10 every 28 days" is not €10 a month. A 28-day cycle renews about thirteen times a year.

Keep access to your home SIM until your bank stops sending codes to it.

Working while you study

The question everyone asks after the TIE, and the answer changed recently in your favour.

Up to 30 hours a week

Under RD 1155/2024, students in higher education may work up to **30 hours per week** without applying for a separate work permit. This was a real change — older guidance you will find online says 20 hours, or says you need a permit. Check the date on anything you read.

Two conditions

The work must be **compatible with your studies**. And your employer needs to see your card or authorisation before you start — they are the ones carrying the risk if you cannot evidence your status.

Different rules apply to post-compulsory vocational training, where the route is formative practice rather than general employment.

It changes your health cover

This is the part nobody mentions. Starting work means Social Security affiliation, and affiliation can replace the private insurance requirement that your authorisation imposed.

Do not cancel a policy on that basis without confirming it against your own authorisation conditions first — but do check, because some students pay for cover they no longer need.

Admin-day survival

Print this page, or screenshot it. It is the only page you need on you.

Say this

SPANISH	ENGLISH
<i>Tengo cita para...</i>	I have an appointment for...
<i>¿Qué documentos me faltan?</i>	Which documents am I missing?
<i>¿Necesito el certificado o el volante?</i>	Do you need the certificate or the volante?
<i>¿Puede hablar más despacio?</i>	Could you speak more slowly?
<i>¿Me lo puede dar por escrito?</i>	Could you give it to me in writing?
<i>¿Cuál es mi número de expediente?</i>	What is my file number?
<i>Necesito ayuda. ¿Habla inglés?</i>	I need help. Do you speak English?

Emergency numbers

112 – police, fire, medical. Free, 24/7.

061 Salut Respon – health guidance, Catalonia.

092 – Guàrdia Urbana, local police.

017 INCIBE – online fraud.

Office hours are not your hours

Most administrative offices deal with the public in the **morning only**, and many close entirely in August and around public holidays. Check the specific office's hours the day before – not the general website's.

Arrive early. A 09:30 appointment is not a 09:30 arrival.

Catalan and Spanish

Both are official here. Municipal websites often default to Catalan – look for the language switch, usually top right, and note that the Spanish version is occasionally less complete.

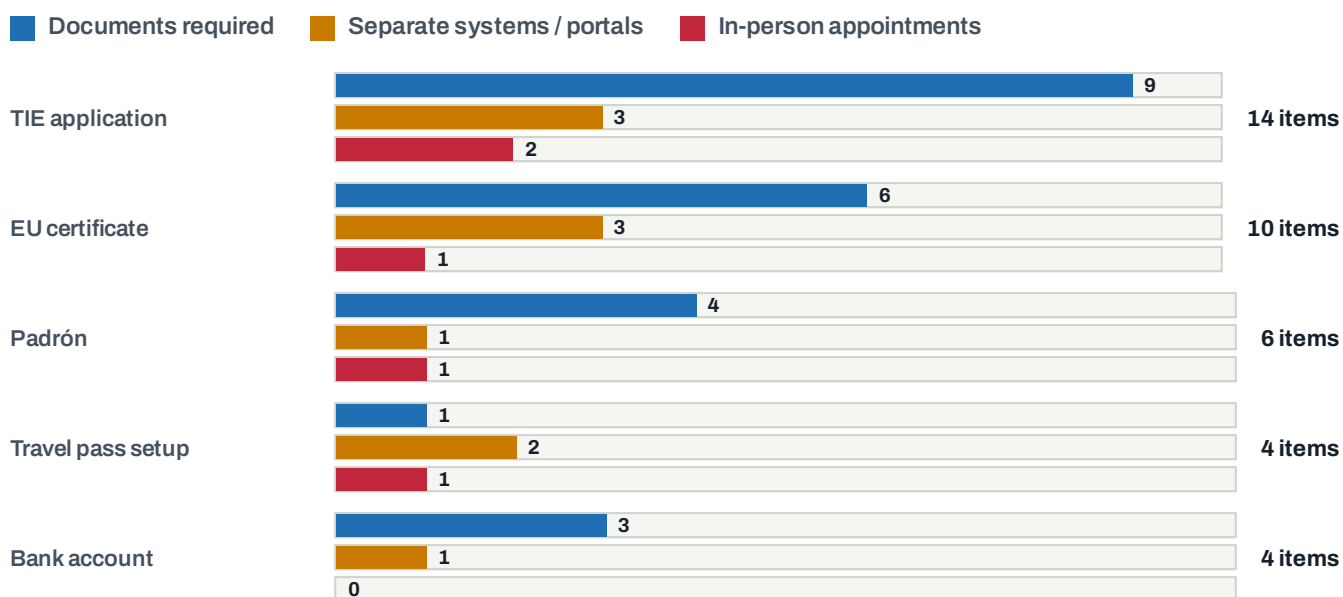
Volant and *certificat* are the Catalan spellings of *volante* and *certificado*. Same documents.

How much work this actually is

No opinions here — just counts. Documents you must produce, separate official systems you must use, and times you have to physically show up somewhere during office hours, in your first term.

How much admin each task creates

Counted from the official checklists, non-EU route



Counts reflect the ordinary published requirements. Local offices may request additional evidence depending on the procedure and your circumstances. Documents counted are the nine on the 05A checklist. The three in-person appearances on the cover are: the padrón counter, the fingerprint appointment, and card collection where a second visit is required.

All of this is genuinely doable alone

Thousands of students do it every September with nothing but patience and this kind of checklist. It's free, it's official, and if you have time in your first fortnight and a bit of Spanish, do it yourself — we'd rather you kept your money. The people who hire us are the ones whose first two weeks are already full.

You've been here two weeks. The clock started the day you landed.

Non-EU students normally have one month from entry to apply for the TIE. If you arrived in the first week of September, that window closes in early October — and the appointment is the part nobody can rush.

START HERE

Free triage, same day

Send us your entry stamp, your authorisation and your enrolment letter. We'll tell you **which route applies, how many days you have left, and what's still recoverable**. No charge, no obligation, and if you don't need us we'll say so.

bcnstudent.com

Triage form · answer the same day

All of this is genuinely doable alone

Thousands of students do it every September with nothing but patience and this kind of checklist. It is free, it is official, and if you have time in your first fortnight and a bit of Spanish, do it yourself — we would rather you kept your money.

Who this is actually for

- You are on a one-year programme with no slack in it
- You do not speak Spanish
- You arrived in the September crush and the clock is already running
- You have already lost one appointment
- Your landlord is being difficult about the padrón

If none of those are you, use the checklists and keep your money.

Why there are two prices

The EU route is less work, so it costs less. No fingerprints, no €16.08 tasa, and where the requirements are met the certificate is normally issued at the appointment itself. Non-EU students need the EX-17, the biometric appointment, and at some offices a separate collection trip.

We confirm which route applies to you at triage, **before you pay anything**.

What the alternatives cost

A *gestoría* charges €150–300 for the paperwork alone — in Spanish, on their schedule, and they will not answer your WhatsApp at 9pm. We cost more than the cheap end of that because the file is built in English, audited line by line, and someone answers.

A wrong appointment type costs you the slot and puts you back in a queue nobody can predict the length of.

Nothing is billed hourly, and no package includes government fees.

Three ways to do this

01

EU / EEA / CH NON-EU

The Ready File

300 € 360 €

The paperwork, finished and in your hands, in 48 hours.

Route confirmed against your own authorisation. We read your visa or approval decision and your entry stamp. EX-18 or EX-17, and the exact date your window closes.

Your form, generated and print-ready. Pre-filled from your verified data, flattened so nothing shifts on print, cross-checked against your passport scan. Second surnames handled correctly. Section 2 — legal representative — left permanently blank, because we are not your representative. The DEHú electronic-notification box left unchecked.

Modelo 790 Código 012, configured for cash. Generated with the barcode the scanner reads, set for payment *en efectivo*, printed in colour at 100% scale. Plus a named branch near your appointment and its counter hours — not every branch takes tax payments from non-customers.

Your padrón file, for the right town hall. Prepared for the council of the municipality you actually live in, which is not always Barcelona.

If the flat isn't in your name. We prepare the authorisation form for the owner or main tenant to sign, and tell you exactly what they need to provide alongside it.

Every copy, already made. Passport, authorisation, enrolment evidence, proof of entry, lease — copied to your office's specification and collated in the order the counter works through them.

Appointments, searched and booked. Padrón and TIE/CUE, on the official portal, **in your own name**, across all Barcelona-province offices rather than only the convenient one. You get a dated itinerary: address, time, what to carry, what will be asked.

A completeness audit before you go. Checked line by line against the official list, including the name-match check that catches middle names present on one document and missing from another.

How it reaches you: courier to your address, or pickup from us — plus the whole file as a print-at-home PDF the moment it's assembled, so a delivery problem never costs you an appointment.

02 · MOST CHOSEN

EU / EEA / CH NON-EU

The Soft Landing

540 € 600 €

The paperwork, plus the cards you should already be holding.

Includes roughly €75 of cards and travel, bought by us and handed to you. Not application forms, not discount codes — the actual cards, working.

Everything in The Ready File, plus:

A T-mobilitat card, in your name, with 90 days already loaded. Registered, Young profile assigned, personalised card issued, pass paid for. You tap and go. If you've spent the last fortnight buying single tickets, this is the line that pays for itself — ten single journeys cost more than a fifth of a 90-day pass.

Under 30 you get **T-jove**: unlimited travel, all seven fare zones, 90 consecutive days from first validation. Thirty or over, **T-usual** for the zones your commute actually needs, and the difference comes back to you.

Your Carnet Jove, activated. Applied for, paid for, and chased through the activation wait so it's live rather than pending.

Your ISIC card. Bought and issued against your enrolment evidence.

A bank account that actually receives money from home.

Including an honest assessment of whether you need a Spanish one at all — an IBAN from another EU member state shouldn't be refused for a SEPA payment simply because it's foreign, and for a lot of students that's the end of the question.

SIM or eSIM sorted. Matched to your real usage, with the 28-day renewal trap explained before you commit to it. A 28-day cycle renews about thirteen times a year, not twelve.

A WhatsApp line for 30 days. Real answers, in English, through the window where questions actually come up.

A live line during your appointment. If you're asked something you don't understand, call us from the counter. You do the talking — we tell you what they want.

The Fixer

Everything above, plus we turn up.

960 €

By application. Two students per intake, because this is the tier we physically attend.

Includes the same ~€75 of cards and travel as The Soft Landing.

Everything in The Soft Landing, plus:

We come to the town hall with you and translate. The padrón appointment, in person, with someone who speaks Catalan and Spanish standing next to you.

The padrón unlock. The step that quietly blocks everything else, and the one most people are stuck on:

- In a hostel, an Airbnb or an unregistered sublet you currently can't register — there are routes, and nobody has told you about them
- Landlord refusing? A refusal doesn't make registration impossible. We ask the council about its alternative verification routes on your behalf
- Wrong municipality? We identify it and handle that council instead

What we will never do is register you at an address you don't live at. That's a fraud problem attached to your immigration file, and it is not worth it to anyone.

Your health card. Once the padrón is through, registration at your local primary care centre and your Catalan health card — plus an English-speaking GP identified within walking distance of where you actually live.

Same-day contract review, before you sign. If you're still viewing flats and someone is pressuring you to commit on the spot, send us the contract and we'll read it that day. Deposit checked against the statutory cap, cancellation terms, bills, and the address-registration clause that decides whether your padrón is possible at all.

Ownership verified at the registry. We pull the *Nota Simple* and confirm the person renting to you has the right to. Holding keys is not proof of ownership.

Move-in condition report. On handover day we photograph every existing defect, meter readings and appliance states into a timestamped, signed PDF, sent to the landlord the same day. Your deposit is one to two months' rent. This is how you get it back.

90-day file tracking, through to collection — including the collection appointment, which some offices require separately, and which you should never book flights around until it's confirmed.

A completion report for whoever's paying. A dated PDF: what was filed, what's registered, what's still pending, your TIE collection date, and the numbers to call in an emergency.

The honest notes

Every one of these is a thing that goes wrong when nobody says it out loud first.

The 790 arrives unpaid, and it has to

It's a barcoded form that must be carried to a bank counter or scanner, paid, and stamped. Online settlement needs a Spanish digital certificate you don't have yet. We configure it, print it and tell you exactly where to take it — **the trip is yours**. An unstamped form ends the appointment.

Our copies are printed copies, not certified ones

We print from the scans you upload. We have never seen your original passport and cannot certify anything. **You carry the originals**; the folder carries what accompanies them.

We cannot make an appointment exist

We search the official portal for up to six weeks. If no slot opens in that window you get **50% back** and keep the entire Ready File — forms, copies, 790, audit — so you're ready the day one does.

Nobody can shortcut this step legally, and any service that tells you otherwise is selling you something it doesn't have.

We don't attend the biometric appointment for you

It requires you, in person, with originals. We prepare, book, brief, and stay reachable on the phone. **The appearance is yours, in your own name.**

Your 90 days start when you tap

The T-jove window runs from first validation, not from purchase. But it's **90 consecutive days** once it starts — not 90 days of use.

T-jove is an age rule, not a student rule

Under 30 only. No university card or Carnet Jove needed to qualify. Thirty or over, we load T-usual and **refund the difference** rather than charge you for a pass you can't hold.

If your window has already closed, we will tell you and we will not take your money

Past the deadline, on an expired or irregular status, or facing a refusal — that needs legal analysis we are not qualified to give. We'll say so at triage and point you to a *colegiado abogado*. We'd rather lose the work.

What's never in the fee

- × Modelo 790 Código 012 and card issuance — paid by you, directly, at a bank
- × Tuition, rent, deposits — we never handle funds for third parties
- × Legal representation or appeals — outside our scope
- × Sworn translation or apostille — we identify what needs it and refer you to a *traductor jurado*

Paying us

Bank transfer or Bizum with a reference. **Never cash**, and never to a personal account without an invoice.

Your documents are stored encrypted and **deleted 30 days after the service ends**. You get a confirmation when they are.

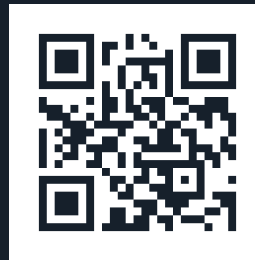
We don't guarantee appointments, we never hold slots without a named client, and we don't give legal advice — complex cases need a professional and we'll tell you.

Where do you actually stand today?

Send us your entry stamp, your authorisation and your enrolment letter. We'll tell you which route applies, how many days you have left, and what is still recoverable. No charge, no obligation.

Free triage, same day

bcnstudent.com



SCAN FOR FREE TRIAGE

IMMIGRATION

Ministry — student authorisations
Interior Ministry — TIE requirements
National Police — EX-17, EX-18
Official appointment portal · tasa 790-012

CITY & PADRÓN

Barcelona City Council — empadronament
Alta al Padró municipal — requirements
T-mobilitat — T-jove fare and zones
CatSalut — obtaining a TSI

RULES CITED HERE

Photo 32×26mm — Ministerio del Interior
30 hours' work — RD 1155/2024
Representation — Ley 39/2015 art. 5
Padrón renewal, 2 years — ENCSARP
Falsification — Código Penal art. 392

EMERGENCIES

112 — police, fire, medical · 24/7
061 Salut Respon — health, Catalonia
092 — Guàrdia Urbana
017 INCIBE — online fraud

Verified per section, not globally. Government fees and transport fares update on different cycles: fees checked 10 Sept 2026 against the current tasa schedule; ATM fares checked 10 Sept 2026 and next reviewed 15 Jan 2027, when Catalan fares change; padrón rules checked 10 Sept 2026. Prices are in euros and change without notice. Recommendations are editorial judgments about convenience and suitability, not guarantees. Always use the official procedure page for the current conditions before you pay anything or attend an appointment.

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